

Kevin Zhang

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EDUCATION

Texas A&M University	Bachelor of Science in Data Engineering	May 2027
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EXPERIENCE

Public Policy Research Institute Software Engineer Intern College Station, TX	Oct 2024 - Present
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- Contributed to multi-year project, rebuilding TIDC website from Classic ASP / ASP.NET (C#) to a modern PHP framework.
- Designed and implemented the website's reporting engine, enabling dynamic data visualization and export features.
- Assisted in developing the forms engine, streamlining data collection and improving site maintainability.

NextCreator Software Engineer Intern Austin, TX	May 2024 - Present
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- Architected and deployed a full-stack web platform using Next.js (frontend) and Node.js/Express (backend) with MongoDB, hosted on a Dockerized DigitalOcean VPS
- Designed and implemented the complete tech stack and infrastructure, including authentication (Clerk), payments (Stripe), file storage (S3), and real-time messaging (Socket.io)

PROJECTS

InkSync · ink-sync-ten.vercel.app/ Next.js, Socket.IO, Canvas API, Gemini API, Groq Whisper API	March 2026
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- Built a collaborative whiteboard with WebSocket-based real-time sync across up to 50 concurrent users
- Implemented AI-powered drawing generation via streaming Gemini API calls and voice-to-drawing input using MediaRecorder + Whisper (Groq) for hands-free prompt entry
- Engineered an AI summarization feature with Gemini API that condenses selected elements into structured descriptions
- Developed a custom smart shape recognition algorithm that classifies freehand pen strokes into geometric primitives
- Designed full import/export pipeline supporting JSON, PNG and SVG file types

StartX · kevvz3742.github.io/StartX JavaScript, HTML/CSS, IndentalDB, Masonry.js, 100r Theming	June 2025
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- Forked and extended an open-source personal knowledge base (Memex) into a hybrid startpage and bookmarking tool
- Engineered custom database parser for human-readable flat-file storage using Indental format, supporting complex filtering by tags, types, projects, and full-text search with real-time URL hash-based routing

2nd Place TidalHack - QuizForge JavaScript, HTML/CSS, RESTful API, Chrome Extensions API, JSON, Python	Nov 2023
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- Built a Chrome browser extension that generates multiple-choice quiz questions from any text the user highlights or pastes in, using a pre-built NLP Python library for question generation

Tactics C#, Unity, Photon PUN, A* Pathfinding	Aug 2022
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- Designed a real-time strategy game in Unity with multiplayer support using the Photon PUN networking engine
- Built core RTS systems including unit command queuing, A* pathfinding, a grid-based building placement system, fog of war, and real-time state synchronization across networked sessions

LEADERSHIP AND AWARDS

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- TidalHack 2023 - 2nd Place Winner
 - Business Professionals of America: C# Programming - 1st National Alternate
 - President's Gold Service Volunteer Award - 500+ Service Hours
 - USACO Silver

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Skills: C#, C++, CSS, HTML, Java, Javascript, PHP, Python, SQL, Typescript

Technologies: Amazon S3, Clerk, DigitalOcean, Electron, Express.js, Flask, Herd, Laravel, MongoDB, MySQL, Next.js, Node.js,

Prisma, Photon PUN, PyTorch, React, scikit-learn, Socket.IO, SQLite, Stripe, Tailwind CSS, Unity, WinForms

Languages: Native Fluency in English, Chinese